NextLeap graduation project | Growth PM case: Groww

Helping first-time Groww investors stay invested through year one

Why early-career salaried investors wobble in months 2 to 12, and an AI check-in that steadies them without giving advice

North-star metric: percentage of first-time mutual fund investors who still have an active SIP 12 months after starting their first one.

11,711 conversations analysed | **4,952** about real SIP journeys | **18**-person survey | Try the live AI discovery engine

Independent study. Not affiliated with Groww. Not investment advice. Mutual fund investments are subject to market risks.

Impact mapping: of about 2 to 3 million first-time Groww SIP investors a year, early-career salaried 22 to 30 are the largest group

India's population ~1.4 billion

Mobile internet users ~958 million
68% of population | IAMAI 2025

Fintech app users 500M+ UPI users
~52% of internet users | NPCI-BCG 2025

Groww active users 16.7 million
~3% of UPI users | Groww Q4 FY26 letter

First-time SIP investors on Groww
~2 to 3 million a year (estimate)

- **Students, under 22**
  29% of first-timers
  ~580K-870K a year
- **Largest group**
  Salaried, 22-30
  51% of first-timers
  ~1.0M-1.5M a year
- **Variable income**
  12% of first-timers
  ~240K-360K a year
- **Mid-career, 31+**
  8% of first-timers
  ~160K-240K a year

The entry door
36% of new Groww users start with a SIP (Q2 FY26, up 7 points on last year).

The leak
SIP stoppage ratio 78.5% in Sep 2026: 63.26 lakh new SIPs vs 49.68 lakh closed or completed.

Estimate logic
~10M of 16.7M users hold mutual funds; 20-30% assumed to start a first SIP in a year. Segment shares: engine, first-year posts stating age or income.

Sources: IAMAI 2025 | NPCI-BCG | Groww letter Q4 FY26 | Groww letter Q2 FY26 | SIP stoppage Sep 2026

Early-career salaried investors (22 to 30) are the largest first-time SIP group, and the most likely to wobble

1 Students and under-22s

Family-funded, small tickets
21% of age-stating posts
6% show a drop-off signal
Needs: expectation-setting

TARGET

2 Early-career salaried, 22 to 30

SIP paid from monthly salary
60% by age | 73% fixed salary
12% drop-off signal (highest)
Needs: pause or reduce, expectation-setting

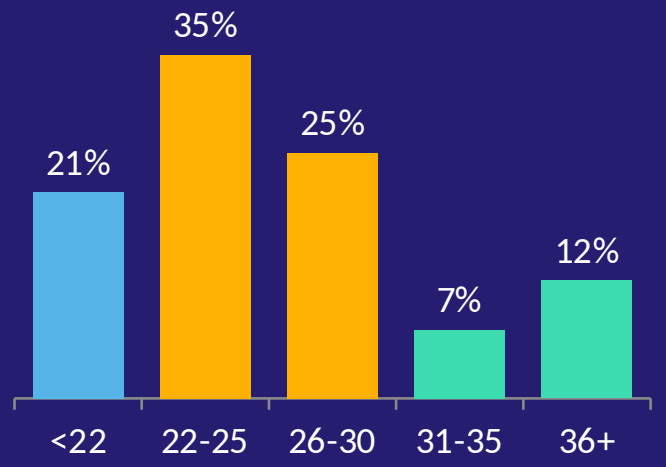
3 Variable-income earners

Freelance, gig, small business
14% of income-stating posts
11% show a drop-off signal
Needs: pause, skip or reduce

4 Mid-career, 31 and over

Goal-led salaried, professionals
19% of age-stating posts
6% show a drop-off signal
Needs: trusted human help

Who states which age (share of 1,130 posts)



63% of first-year investors who state age are 22 to 30. **45%** of Groww active users are under 30; median first-time investor age is about 25 to 26.

Segments built from what 4,952 SIP posts say about the writer; drop-off signal = paused, reduced, stopped, considering stopping or failed instalment.

Three hypotheses on why early-career salaried investors wobble in their first 12 months

1 The expectation gap

They start for long-term wealth and expect steady growth. The first statement shows a small or negative number they cannot interpret, and doubt begins.

- 43% started for long-term wealth; 74% expect steady growth
- They look first at returns % and current value (62% of mentions); drop-offs sound confused or anxious 62% vs 27% of continuers
- Reassurance, expectation-setting and plain language: 48% of first-year needs

Interview: what did you expect at month 3, and what did you see?

2 The cash squeeze with no middle path

In a tight month the visible choices are keep paying or cancel. Skipping is limited, so people stop or miss an instalment.

- Salaried drop-off signal is 12%, double the 6% of students and 31+; cash-flow pressure leads (32 of 78)
- 22% of drop-off signals ask for a way to pause or reduce
- Survey: 3 of 18 missed an instalment, all on Groww; 'needed money' cited 4 times

Interview: did you know you could pause, skip or reduce? What happened?

3 The silent wobble: nobody to ask in the app

When unsure, they ask YouTube, Reddit or friends, or do nothing and drift. Doubt goes unanswered inside the app.

- Outside the app: YouTube 38%, Reddit 32%, Google 12%
- Survey: 9 of 18 did nothing after thinking of stopping; 4 asked a friend, 3 followed influencers
- Continuing needs a plain answer to 'is this normal?' and a reversible option

Interview: who did you ask, what did they say, what stayed unclear?

Covers: why they started | what the experience has been | pause, reduce or stop triggers | what they check | what they do outside the app | what keeps them going. Interviews (5 to 6) will confirm or kill each one.

Pain points: investors cannot tell if what they see is normal, and the app gives no middle path

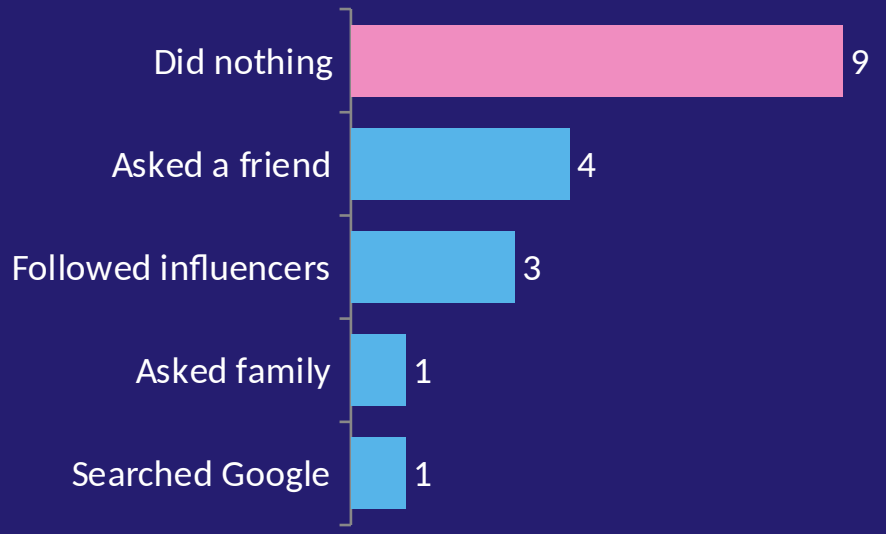
1 Survey snapshot (n=18)

9 of 18 thought of stopping or pausing

3 of 18 missed an instalment (all on Groww)

9 of 18 did nothing next

What they did after a moment of doubt (people)



Top five pain points and blockers

1. **No baseline for "is this normal?"**
   Reassurance, expectation-setting and plain-language needs make up 48% of first-year needs (n=1,063).

2. **Screens that are hard to read**
   First-year confusion: SIP dates and status 30%, autopay mandate 18%, returns vs invested 14%.

3. **No middle path**
   22% of drop-off signals ask to pause or reduce; cash-flow pressure leads for salaried investors.

4. **Failed instalments go unseen**
   18% of stated drop reasons are broken SIPs (payment, mandate, app); 3 of 18 survey respondents missed one.

5. **Help lives outside the app**
   YouTube 38%, Reddit 32%; visible drop-offs sound confused, anxious or frustrated 62% vs 27% of continuers.

Sources: discovery engine on 11,711 conversations; survey n=18 (screener to be repeated with interviews).

True problem: at the wobble moment, investors cannot read what they see or act on what they feel

1 What is the true problem?

Between months 2 and 12, a small or negative number, a tight month or a scary headline triggers doubt. Investors cannot tell if it is normal, the app offers only keep paying or cancel, and help sits on YouTube, Reddit and friends. Continuation breaks at the decision moment, not at the decision to start.

2 Who faces it?

Early-career salaried first-time investors, 22 to 30, three to twelve months into a SIP paid from monthly salary. 60% of posts that state age; 63% of first-year ones; an estimated 2 to 3 million a year on Groww.

3 How do we know it is real?

- 43% of stated drop reasons are about understanding and expectations (n=512)
- 9 of 18 surveyed considered stopping; 9 did nothing
- Industry SIP stoppage ratio 78.5% (Sep 2026)

4 What value does solving it create?

For investors: calm clarity at the wobble moment, a baseline for what is normal, a reversible option instead of a cliff, fewer silent lapses.
For Groww: a higher 12-month active-SIP rate. Each +1 point keeps roughly 20,000 to 30,000 investors a year (estimate), with more lifetime assets and fees, fewer support contacts and compounding trust.

5 Why solve it now?

- Acquisition works, retention lags: record Rs 32,490 crore monthly SIPs yet a 78.5% stoppage ratio
- 36% of new Groww users start SIP-first
- AI can now answer from real conversations with built-in checks

MVP: SIP Check-in, an eval-gated AI that explains what investors see and never what to buy

1 Trigger

Opens from the month 2 to 6 statement or when an investor taps pause or cancel

2 Inputs

Months in, amount band, return shown, what worries them (chips). English, Hindi or Hinglish

3 AI answer

2 to 3 calm sentences: what the number means and what similar investors said or did, cited from real conversations

4 Quality gate

Grounded, no advice, numbers verified. If any check fails: safe fallback with AMFI, SEBI and Groww support links

Where AI earns its place

It reads the investor's own numbers and worry in their language, retrieves similar real cases, and writes a calm explanation at the exact moment of doubt.

What a non-AI version misses

A static FAQ cannot tailor to month, amount and worry. Rules can compute returns but not tell cash stress from confusion. Advisors do not scale to millions.

Eval gate before launch

Ships only if the golden set shows 95%+ grounded answers, zero advice or return-prediction language, and 100% refusal of fund-pick and injection tests. Engine today: 19/19 tricky questions handled, 11/12 answers grounded.

Not investment advice. No fund names, no return predictions, no fear or urgency. Pause and cancel are never blocked.

Retrieval core already live: **discovery engine**

Success: lift 12-month active SIPs, tracked by leading indicators, guardrails and AI quality gates

North star: % of first-time investors with at least one successful instalment in the last 30 days, 12 months after their first SIP. Target: +2 to +3 points vs a control group (set from Groww baseline).

Leading indicators

Move in weeks, not 12 months

Wobble-to-continue: % who open Check-in at a pause or cancel moment and still have an active SIP 30 days later

Month-6 survival: % of the cohort with an active SIP at month 6

Middle-path use: % of SIP changes made by pause or reduce rather than cancel

Clarity rate: % answering yes to 'did this make things clearer?' (goal 70%+)

Guardrails

Make sure we do no harm

Advice language: 0 advice or return-prediction phrases per 1,000 outputs

Cancel stays easy: cancel rate and time to cancel not worse than control

Support load: contacts and complaints do not rise

No pressure: average SIP amount not pushed up by the feature

AI output quality

Measured on the golden set, weekly

Grounded: 95%+ of claims supported by cited sources (today 11 of 12 answers)

Retrieval precision@5: 75%+ (today 43 to 78% across runs)

Label agreement: 85%+ relevance, 70%+ reason and need (hand labels pending)

Safe fallback: 100% refusal on advice and injection tests (today 19/19)

Each leading metric sits on the path to the north star; each guardrail guards a way the feature could hurt investors.

Risks: advice drift, wrong answers and pressure nudges matter most, and each has a built-in safeguard

1 Read as investment advice

Mitigation: No fund or stock names, no return predictions, 'not advice' on every output, refusal tests, legal review before launch.

2 Wrong or invented answers

Mitigation: Answers only from retrieved sources, numbers checked by code, golden-set release gate, failed checks fall back to AMFI and SEBI links, kill switch.

3 Retention pressure harms people who need cash

Mitigation: No urgency or fear. Pause, reduce and cancel stay one tap away. Guardrail on cancel rate and time.

4 Biased evidence

Mitigation: Public posts skew to vocal, experienced users and miss silent lapsers. Add 5 to 6 interviews and Groww cohort data, state the bias, A/B test against control.

5 Low adoption or extra friction

Mitigation: Show only at wobble moments, test wording, track opens and drop-off, never block the flow.

6 Privacy and free-tier limits

Mitigation: No PAN, account or portfolio data; inputs are bands and percentages, not stored. Saved verified answers, caching and fallbacks cover quota limits.

Known limit today: the engine's strict judge still flags occasional over-generalised answers, so unverified answers are hidden, not shown.

How the evidence was built: an AI discovery engine reads 11,711 real conversations and is tested against a golden set

1 Collect

40,000 Play Store reviews, 38.5K Reddit posts and 15.9K comments, 15.8K YouTube comments

2 Filter and sample

Remove duplicates, keep SIP and mutual-fund talk, seeded sampling: 21,073 items

3 AI extraction

Gemini codes each item: what happened, why, feeling, needs, why started, confusion, age. 11,711 analysed, 4,952 relevant

4 Check

Quotes must appear word for word (98.5%). A stricter prompt removed 28% false 'relevant' items such as ULIP and PPF

5 Answer (RAG)

Question, search terms, keyword and meaning search, AI re-rank, 2 to 3 sentence answer, four self-checks

6 Evaluate

19/19 tricky questions handled; precision@5 43 to 78%; 11/12 answers grounded; hand-labelled golden set to score extraction

Next: 5 to 6 interviews with early-career salaried first-time investors to confirm or kill the three hypotheses, then build and test the MVP. **Try the live engine**

Free-tier stack: Gemini models, Vercel hosting. Data: public reviews, posts and comments shown as short excerpts without usernames.